

Compare & Contrast Essay

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INTRODUCTION

- A comparison, incidentally, is the process of showing how things are alike
- A contrast is the process of showing differences.
- Generally in academic writing, the word “comparison” is used to refer to both comparison and contrast.
- A comparison and contrast essay can be both informative and persuasive.

Planning a Comparison and Contrast Essay

Pick Two Ideas

Selecting two ideas to compare or contrast

Analyze Ideas in Detail

Conducting a detailed analysis of both ideas

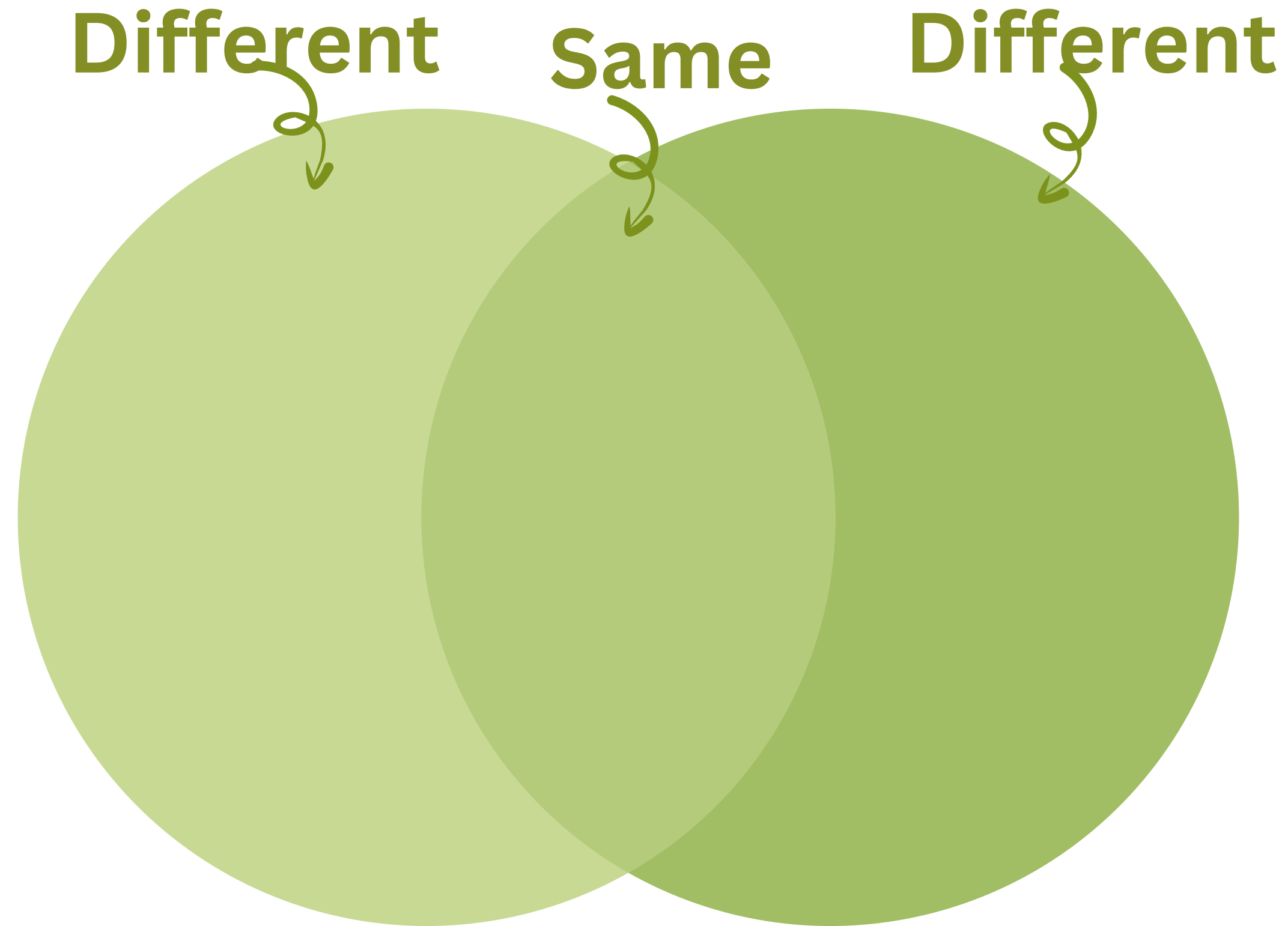
Inventory Similarities and Differences

Listing out the similarities and differences

Ensure Fairness

Ensuring the comparison is unbiased and fair

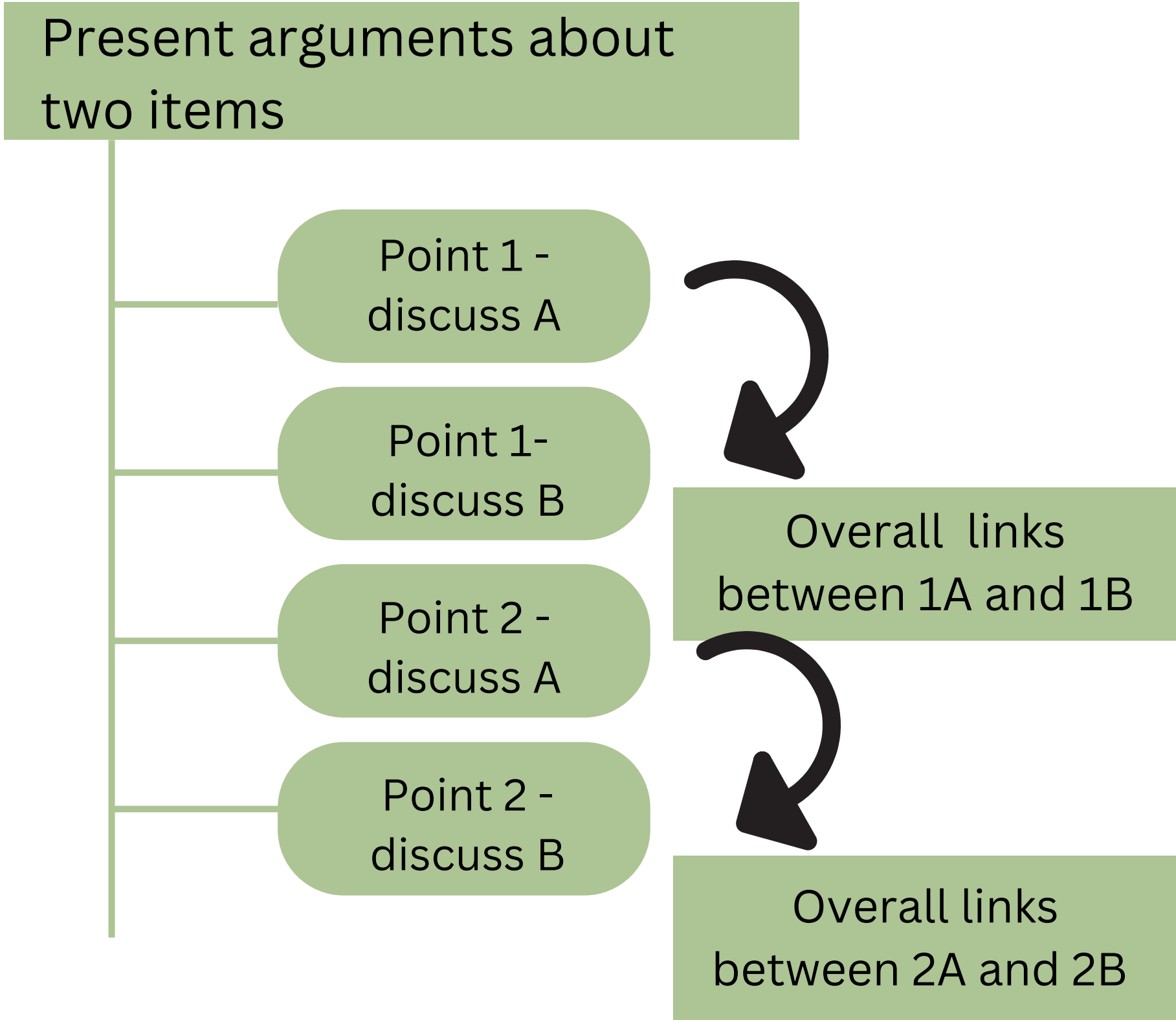
Use Venn Diagram to Outline Compare and Contrast Essay



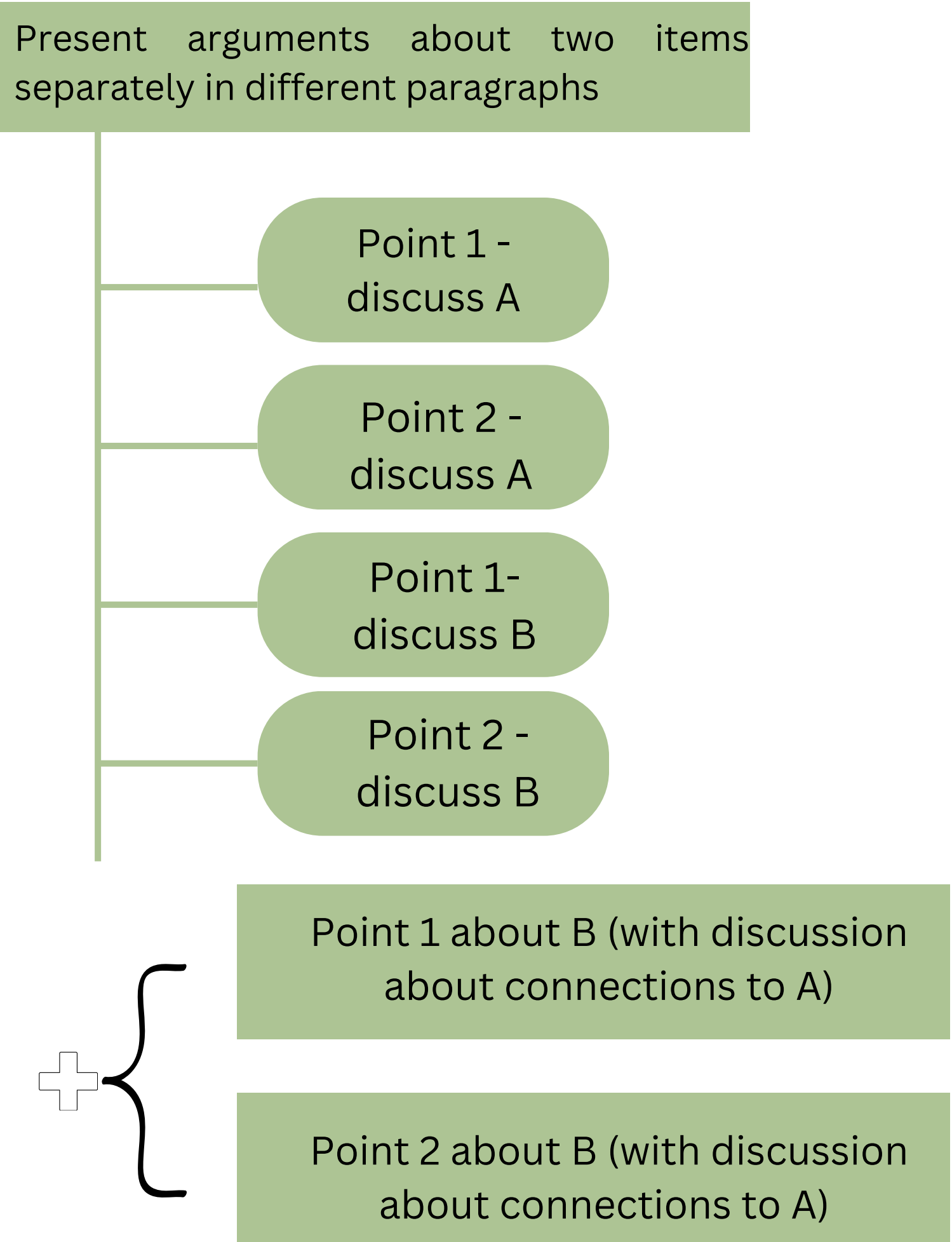
BASIC FORMAT OF COMPARE AND CONTRAST ESSAY

- Introduction and Thesis Statement (one paragraph).
- Topic One (at least one paragraph, can be more, discussing just one of the ideas, people, or objects being discussed in great detail).
- Topic Two (will follow the same guidelines as topic one).
- Topic One and Topic Two Together (analyze both topics together, can be one or more paragraphs).
- Conclusion (sum up the compare and contrast essay, should generalize the thesis and should reaffirm the thesis).

Point-by-Point Arrangement



Block Arrangement



POINT-BY-POINT METHOD OUTLINE EXAMPLE

Thesis: John Stewart Mill and Michael Bakunin both support three of the basic principles of democracy (government by the people, tolerance, and equality); however, they support them to different degrees and for different reasons.

POINT 1

Paragraph 1

- Mill believes that the majority makes moral decisions.
- Bakunin believes that public opinion should be the basis of society's decisions, which is lightly different than Mill's understanding of a moral majority.

POINT 2

Paragraph 2

- Mill argues that complete open-mindedness always benefits society.
- Unlike Mill, Bakunin allows freedom of expression to be limited by public opinion.

POINT 3

Paragraph 3

- Mill claims that we are all equal because mere accident determines what worldview we are born into.
- As with Mill, Bakunin extends equality to all and embraces diversity.

BLOCK METHOD OUTLINE EXAMPLE

Thesis: Same as in Point-by-Point Method Outline.

PARA 1

Point 1: Mill believes that the majority makes moral decisions.

Point 2: Mill argues that complete open-mindedness always benefits society

Point 3: Mill claims that we are all equal because mere accident determines what worldview we are born into.

PARA 2

Point 1: Bakunin believes that public opinion should be the basis of society's decisions, which is slightly different than Mill's understanding of a moral majority.

Point 2: Unlike Mill, Bakunin allows freedom of expression to be limited by public opinion.

Point 3: As with Mill, Bakunin extends equality to all and embraces diversity.

COMMON TRANSITIONAL EXPRESSIONS...

Transitional Expressions for Contrast

conversely	nevertheless
however	on the contrary
in contrast	on the one hand
in opposition	on the other hand
although, even though, whereas, while*	but, yet [†]

Transitional expressions in comparison paragraphs stress *similarities*:

Transitional Expressions for Comparison

also	in a similar way
as well	in the same way
equally	likewise
in addition	similarly

SOME WAYS NOT TO BEGIN YOUR PARAGRAPHS

- This essay is about...
- In this assignment I will share with you..
- I am going to tell you about...
- I think..
- My first idea is about...



DON'T USE GENERAL STATEMENTS LIKE...

- Everybody does...
- Everyone knows...
- Nobody wants...
- Anyone can see...
- Last time I checked, this was still...



**Check page # 132- 135 for the
sample essay**